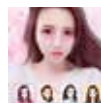


Bazaar

All the latest and greatest products tested and reviewed so you make an informed buying decision.

**Meitu, the makeover app**

Meitu is an app on Android and iOS that lets you transform selfies into an adorable anime character. <http://dgit.in/MeituApp1>

THE BUDGET MOBILE CAMERA FACEOFF

FIVE BUDGET SMARTPHONES, EACH WITH THEIR OWN SET OF PROS AND CONS, FACE OFF IN OUR COMPARISON THIS MONTH. AND THEY THREATEN HIGHER PRICED SMARTPHONES IN TERMS OF SHEER IMAGING PERFORMANCE.



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Budget smartphones have escalated in diversity to a great extent. The sub-18k smartphone category has been steadily including better cameras, and now even includes dual-camera setups, higher grade sensors and wider lenses to denote a paradigm shift in budget smartphone cameras.

Take for instance the likes of the newly launched Coolpad Cool1, Honor 6X and Xiaomi Redmi Note 4, along with the benchmark-setting Lenovo Z2 Plus and the offline-market-focused Vivo V5, and we have an interesting assortment of the best smartphone cameras aligned to face off against each other. The Honor 6X and the Coolpad Cool1 offer dual-camera units, while the Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 offers a notable improvement over

its popular predecessor. The Lenovo Z2 Plus is the best-performing smartphone for its budget. The Vivo V5 admittedly does not put emphasis on its rear camera. However, it does include a fairly competent and balanced output of imaging, performance and other aspects.

It is because of this that we chose these specific smartphones to see how far budget smartphones have progressed, and which of these lead the pack. Many have billed dual-

camera units heavily, based on their refocusing and background defocus capabilities. However, do they really make a difference in this category, or are single-camera units equally proficient? This is exactly what we tried to find in this shootout, which involved shooting in daylight, indoors and low light, along with evaluations based on the camera app, the versatility of the camera units, and which one produces the most balanced photographs.